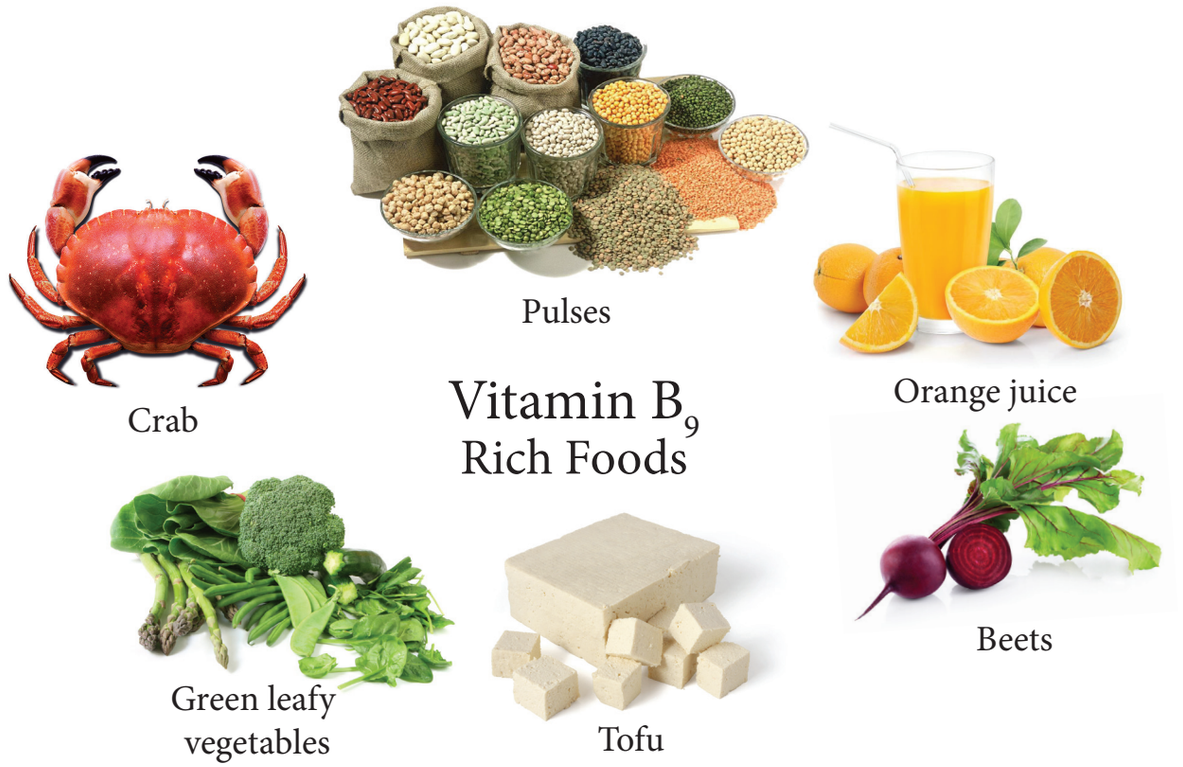


Fig 11.15: Food Sources of Vitamin B_9

- Folic acid helps the body to convert carbohydrates into glucose, which is used to provide energy.
- Folic acid helps in building of antibodies which prevent and heal infections.
- It helps in normal functioning of the nervous system and maintains the mental and emotional health.
- It helps in production of body's generic material - DNA and RNA.

Food sources of Folic acid: The rich sources of folate are fish, mutton, liver, egg, chicken, green leafy vegetables, pulses, Lentils, beans, asparagus, lettuce, Parsley, avocado, sunflower seeds, beets, broccoli, spinach, orange juice, tofu, fish, meat, fortified cereals, milk, cheese, eggs, oysters, crab etc.,

Symptoms of folic acid deficiency

- A recent study connected folic acid deficiency with autism.
- Loss of memory, severe and irreversible damage to nervous system and brain.
- Deficiency of folic acid causes megaloblastic anaemia.

11.3.6 Vitamin B_{12} (Cyanocobalamin)

The vitamin is named as cyanocobalamin because of the presence of cobalt and cyanide in its structure. It can be absorbed in the body only in the presence of intrinsic factor (IF).

UNIT-11_174-207.indd 186 23-01-2020 10:18:36